

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Nature and Significance of Political Theory - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Nature and Significance of Political Theory

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 The Field, Its Scope and Its Exam Significance

2 Essential Vocabulary of Political Inquiry

3 The Facts-Logic-Values Argument

4 Science, Philosophy, Theory and Ideology

5 Thinkers, Positions and Illustrative Applications

6 Comparison Matrix and UPSC Trap Repair

7 Ownership Boundaries and the Revision Spine

8 The Decline and Revival Debate

9 Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture

10 Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Nature and Significance of Political Theory - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g3 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political theory**?

A. Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16). B. The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20). C. Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gauba still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gaubu, PDF pp.16-17, 20). D. Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaubu, PDF pp.19-20).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political theory** with **Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**.

A. David Held B. Political theory C. Key danger D. Logical statement

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16)** with **Political theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical statement**?

A. Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gaubu, PDF p.16). B. Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gaubu, PDF pp.18-19, 23). C. A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaubu, PDF p.16). D. If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gaubu, PDF p.23).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical statement** with **A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**.

A. David Easton B. "Critically analyse/evaluate" C. Evaluative statement D. Empirical statement

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaubu, PDF p.16)** with **Empirical statement**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Logical statement**?

A. A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gaubu, PDF p.16). B. Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaubu, PDF p.20). C. The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gaubu, PDF p.15). D. His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Logical statement** with **A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**.

A. Basic concern B. Logical statement C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Political science

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gaubu, PDF p.16)** with **Logical statement**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Evaluative statement**?

A. Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20). B. Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gaubu, PDF p.17). C. A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gaubu, PDF p.16). D. Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Evaluative statement** with **A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gaubu, PDF p.16)**.

A. Main method B. Political theory C. Political philosophy D. Evaluative statement

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gaubu, PDF p.16)** with **Evaluative statement**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political science**?

A. The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18). B. Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaubu, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaubu, PDF p.19). C. Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18). D.

Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gauba, PDF p.18).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political science** with **The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

A. Typical question B. Political science C. Empirical statement D. Public vs private

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18). with **Political science**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political philosophy**?

A. Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gauba still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gauba, PDF pp.16-17, 20). B. Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gauba, PDF pp.19-20). C. The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20). D. What happens, why, and with what regularities?

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political philosophy** with **The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20).

A. Key danger B. Logical statement C. Theory vs ideology D. Political philosophy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life** (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20). with **Political philosophy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Public vs private**?

A. Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gauba, PDF p.16). B. Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23). C. If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gauba, PDF p.23). D. If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Public vs private** with **Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary** (Gauba, PDF p.16).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gaubu, PDF p.16).**

A. "Critically analyse/evaluate" B. Public vs private C. Evaluative statement D. Political science vs political philosophy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gaubu, PDF p.16).** with **Public vs private**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Theory vs ideology?**

A. The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gaubu, PDF p.15). B. His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25). C. Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaubu, PDF p.20). D. Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Theory vs ideology** with **Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaubu, PDF p.20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaubu, PDF p.20).**

A. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) B. Political science C. Explanation vs justification D. Theory vs ideology

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaubu, PDF p.20).** with **Theory vs ideology**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political science vs political philosophy?**

A. Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20). B. Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gaubu, PDF p.17). C. Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18). D. Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political science vs political philosophy** with **Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaub, PDF pp.17-20).**

A. Political theory B. Political science vs political philosophy C. Political philosophy D. Empirical/logical vs evaluative

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaub, PDF pp.17-20).** with **Political science vs political philosophy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Explanation vs justification**?

A. Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gaub, PDF pp.17-18). B. Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gaub, PDF p.18). C. Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaub, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaub, PDF p.19). D. Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaub, PDF p.16).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Explanation vs justification** with **Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaub, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaub, PDF p.19).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaub, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaub, PDF p.19).**

A. Empirical statement B. Public vs private C. Behavioural vs post-behavioural D. Explanation vs justification

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaub, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaub, PDF p.19).** with **Explanation vs justification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical/logical vs evaluative**?

A. Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gaub still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gaub, PDF pp.16-17, 20). B. Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.19-20). C. What happens, why, and with what regularities? D. A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaub, PDF p.16).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical/logical vs evaluative** with **Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gaub still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gaub, PDF pp.16-17, 20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gaub still treats**

them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gauba, PDF pp.16-17, 20).

A. Logical statement B. Empirical/logical vs evaluative C. Theory vs ideology D. Sheldon S. Wolin

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gauba still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gauba, PDF pp.16-17, 20).** with **Empirical/logical vs evaluative**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Behavioural vs post-behavioural**?

A. If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gauba, PDF p.23). B. If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23). C. Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23). D. A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gauba, PDF p.16).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behavioural vs post-behavioural** with **Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).**

A. Evaluative statement B. Political science vs political philosophy C. George Catlin D. Behavioural vs post-behavioural

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).** with **Behavioural vs post-behavioural**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sheldon S. Wolin**?

A. The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gauba, PDF p.15). B. His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gauba, PDF pp.24-25). C. Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict. D. A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gauba, PDF p.16).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sheldon S. Wolin** with **The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gauba, PDF p.15).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gauba, PDF p.15).**

A. Political science B. Sheldon S. Wolin C. Explanation vs justification D. Andrew Hacker

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gauba, PDF p.15).** with **Sheldon S. Wolin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **George Catlin**?

A. Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18). B. Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18). C. Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gauba, PDF p.17). D. The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **George Catlin** with **Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gauba, PDF p.17).**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gauba, PDF p.17).**

A. Political philosophy B. Empirical/logical vs evaluative C. D.D. Raphael D. George Catlin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gauba, PDF p.17).** with **George Catlin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Andrew Hacker**?

A. Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18). B. Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gauba, PDF p.18). C. Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gauba, PDF p.16). D. The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Andrew Hacker** with **Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).**

A. Public vs private B. Andrew Hacker C. Behavioural vs post-behavioural D. David Held

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).** with **Andrew**

Hacker. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **D.D. Raphael**?

A. What happens, why, and with what regularities? B. A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gaub, PDF p.16). C. Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.19-20). D. Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gaub, PDF p.16).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **D.D. Raphael** with **Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.19-20)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.19-20)**.

A. Theory vs ideology B. Sheldon S. Wolin C. David Easton D. D.D. Raphael

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political philosophy should be recognized by its critical and justificatory function, plus concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.19-20)** with **D.D. Raphael**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Held**?

A. If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gaub, PDF p.23). B. If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gaub, PDF pp.20, 23). C. A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gaub, PDF p.16). D. Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gaub, PDF p.20).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Held** with **If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gaub, PDF p.23)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gaub, PDF p.23)**.

A. Political science vs political philosophy B. David Held C. George Catlin D. Basic concern

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **If political theory is not systematically pursued, politics may be left to ignorance, self-interest or mere will to power (Gaub, PDF p.23)** with **David Held**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton**?

A. Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict. B. A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gaub, PDF p.16). C. His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the

founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25). D. Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton** with **His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25)**.

A. Explanation vs justification B. Andrew Hacker C. Main method D. David Easton

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **His 1953 behavioural critique and 1969 post-behavioural correction are reconstructed in full in §12 below; even at the founding-definition stage he matters because post-behaviouralism reopens the value-question rather than abolishing science (Gaubu, PDF pp.24-25)** with **David Easton**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Basic concern**?

A. Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18). B. Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18). C. The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18). D. Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gaubu, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gaubu, PDF p.19).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Basic concern** with **Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18)**.

A. Empirical/logical vs evaluative B. Basic concern C. D.D. Raphael D. Typical question

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Facts of political life and actual behaviour (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18)** with **Basic concern**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Main method**?

A. Systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16). B. The component of theory concerned with justification, criticism, concept-clarification and the ends of political life (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-20). C. Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gaubu, PDF p.18). D. Empirical and logical claims are presented as verifiable; evaluative claims concern value-judgment, but Gaubu still treats them as rationally discussable rather than mere emotion (Gaubu, PDF pp.16-17, 20).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Main method** with **Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gaubu, PDF p.18)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong

to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gauba, PDF p.18).**

A. Behavioural vs post-behavioural B. David Held C. Key danger D. Main method

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Observation, generalization, explanation, prediction and prescription (Gauba, PDF p.18).** with **Main method**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Typical question?**

A. What happens, why, and with what regularities? B. A statement based on observation through sense-experience alone (Gauba, PDF p.16). C. Politics concerns the public sphere; not every social or cultural activity is political unless regulation for public order or safety becomes necessary (Gauba, PDF p.16). D. Behaviouralism privileges scientific study of actual behaviour; post-behaviouralism restores concern for values without discarding scientific work on facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Typical question** with **What happens, why, and with what regularities?**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **What happens, why, and with what regularities?**

A. Sheldon S. Wolin B. Typical question C. David Easton D. "Critically analyse/evaluate"

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **What happens, why, and with what regularities?** with **Typical question**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Key danger?**

A. A statement based on reasoning, such as formal or inferential relations (Gauba, PDF p.16). B. Theory is dispassionate and disinterested; ideology is interested and justificatory toward a particular distribution of power (Gauba, PDF p.20). C. If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23). D. The political is uniquely concerned with what is common to the whole community (Gauba, PDF p.15).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Key danger** with **If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23).**

A. George Catlin B. Basic concern C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Key danger

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **If isolated, it may become value-blind or selectively descriptive (Gauba, PDF pp.20, 23).** with **Key danger**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to

different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Critically analyse/evaluate"**?

A. Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict. B. A statement based on value-judgment about what is right, good or desirable (Gauba, PDF p.16). C. Science asks what the real situation is and which regularities govern behaviour; philosophy asks what is good, right or justified in political life (Gauba, PDF pp.17-20). D. Political theory is divided into political science and political philosophy; science studies control and facts, philosophy studies ends and values (Gauba, PDF p.17).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Critically analyse/evaluate"** with **Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict.**

A. Andrew Hacker B. "Critically analyse/evaluate" C. Main method D. Political theory

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Weigh the behavioural critique against the post-behavioural/Straussian revival and give a reasoned verdict.** with **"Critically analyse/evaluate"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**?

A. The component of theory concerned with facts, observation, explanation and generalized propositions about political behaviour (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18). B. Raphael's distinction, endorsed by Gauba, is that science seeks explanation whereas philosophy seeks justification (Gauba, PDF p.19). C. Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18). D. Every political scientist is part scientist and part philosopher; theory needs both factual understanding and a view of political goals (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)** with **Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18).**

A. D.D. Raphael B. Typical question C. Empirical statement D. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Scale depth of illustration and number of thinkers cited (§18).** with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain why political theory cannot be reduced either to empirical political science or to normative political philosophy. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Political theory is systematic knowledge of political phenomena. Because political life contains empirical, logical and evaluative claims, the discipline cannot be confined to only one kind of inquiry.

Core analysis: Political science contributes observation, comparison, causal explanation and tested generalisation. Political philosophy contributes concept-clarification, criticism and justification of ends. Raphael's distinction is useful: science primarily explains, while philosophy asks whether institutions and purposes are justified. Political theory joins these tasks because evidence cannot itself decide which ends deserve pursuit, while normative judgment without knowledge of institutions and consequences becomes abstract.

Critical evaluation: The synthesis does not erase methodological differences. Empirical claims remain answerable to evidence and evaluative claims require reasons. The point is complementarity, not an undifferentiated mixture.

Conclusion: Political theory is therefore strongest as a disciplined synthesis: political science explains facts and means, while political philosophy clarifies and justifies values and ends.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish political theory from ideology and show why the distinction matters. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Political theory and ideology both organise political ideas, but they differ in their relation to criticism and power.

Core analysis: Political theory examines concepts and claims through evidence, logic and normative argument. Ideology, in Gauba's account, is an interested body of ideas that justifies or seeks a particular distribution of power and is commonly accepted by adherents without equivalent testing. Theory therefore asks whether a claim is valid; ideology chiefly mobilises, legitimates and directs action. The distinction matters because the same language of liberty, equality or order may either open inquiry or close it around a prior commitment.

Critical evaluation: No thinker is wholly detached from social location, so the contrast is an analytical ideal rather than a claim that theory is socially innocent. Its value lies in preserving the duty of self-criticism.

Conclusion: The distinction matters because political judgment becomes answer-worthy only when inherited commitments are exposed to criticism rather than protected as unquestionable ideology.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Examine the claim that the decline of political theory was the decline of one mode of inquiry rather than the disappearance of theory. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The mid-twentieth-century decline thesis concerned the weakening of traditional normative and historical political theory, not the disappearance of all systematic reflection on politics.

Core analysis: Behaviouralism criticised speculative reasoning, weak causal explanation and excessive dependence on the history of ideas. Easton's 1953 intervention demanded a more scientific discipline, while Lipset suggested that liberal democracy had resolved the major ideological questions of the good society. Yet these positions still contained theoretical assumptions about relevance, explanation and political value. The later revival, represented by Strauss, Germino and Marcuse, restored the need to judge tyranny, justice and domination. Easton's post-behavioural correction also reintroduced relevance and values without abandoning empirical work.

Further development: The rival decline claims must also be separated. Cobban lamented the loss of criteria for judgment, Lipset treated liberal democracy as the achieved good society, and early Easton criticised speculative method. They diagnose different problems. The revival was therefore not one event but the recovery of normative judgment, perennial questions and critical social theory.

Critical evaluation: The decline thesis is therefore credible only as a change in disciplinary style. Political inquiry could not avoid concepts, ends and judgments, even when it described itself as value-free.

Conclusion: The defensible verdict is that mid-century behaviouralism displaced a traditional mode of theory, but the unavoidable need to judge ends ensured theory's revival in a revised form.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss the contribution of the behavioural and post-behavioural movements to the development of political theory. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism changed political theory by successively demanding scientific rigour and socially relevant judgment.

Core analysis: Behaviouralism shifted attention from formal institutions and textual commentary to observable political behaviour, comparison, generalisation and causal explanation. It exposed vague speculation and strengthened the empirical component of theory. Its limitation was the tendency to equate valid knowledge with value-neutral fact, leaving no adequate basis for choosing political ends. Post-behaviouralism responded by insisting that relevance, values and urgent public problems must guide inquiry, while retaining the empirical achievements of behavioural research.

Further development: The transition also changed the researcher's role. Behavioural detachment protected inquiry from partisan assertion, but Germino's distinction between detachment and ethical neutrality showed why method could not settle purpose. Post-behaviouralism retained verification and comparison while asking whether research addressed domination, injustice and urgent public problems.

Critical evaluation: Post-behaviouralism is not a return to unsupported moralism. Its contribution is a division of labour in which science clarifies facts and means, while normative reasoning evaluates purposes and consequences.

Conclusion: Behaviouralism strengthened empirical discipline, while post-behaviouralism restored relevance and values; their durable contribution lies in combining methodological rigour with public purpose.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Critically analyse the nature, functions and continuing significance of political theory. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Political theory is the systematic, critical and evaluative study of political life, combining explanation of institutions with judgment about their purposes.

Core analysis: Its descriptive function identifies political structures and behaviour; its explanatory function relates causes and consequences; its critical function tests prevailing distributions of power; its reconstructive function develops better institutional possibilities; and its clarificatory function distinguishes concepts such as liberty, authority and justice. Political theory also disciplines disagreement by requiring reasons and encouraging toleration. David Held's warning is relevant: without theory, political action is easily surrendered to ignorance, self-interest or will to power.

Further development: Wolin identifies politics with concerns common to the community; Catlin divides inquiry into science and philosophy; Hacker treats every political scientist as partly both; and Raphael distinguishes explanation from justification. These positions show why the discipline must connect public power, causal knowledge and defensible ends. Strauss further demonstrates that a value-neutral vocabulary cannot rank tyranny below justice, while Marcuse warns that measurement can normalise domination. The strongest objection is ideological capture: theory may universalise a partisan order. Its reply is not withdrawal from judgment but transparent premises, counter-argument and revisability.

Critical evaluation: Theory can become ideological when it hides its assumptions, and it can become empty when detached from evidence. Its continuing significance therefore depends on explicit premises, empirical responsiveness and openness to revision.

Conclusion: Political theory remains indispensable because description without criticism legitimates the status quo, while prescription without evidence becomes abstraction.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate the decline-and-revival debate with reference to Easton, Strauss, Germino and Marcuse. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The decline-and-revival debate concerns whether scientific political inquiry can dispense with normative judgment.

Core analysis: Easton's 1953 critique attacked traditional theory for speculation and weak causal tools. Strauss replied that positivist science cannot explain why tyranny is inferior to justice if it refuses to rank values. Germino distinguished intellectual detachment from ethical neutrality and treated revival as recovery of enduring philosophical questions. Marcuse added a critical argument: apparently neutral social science may normalise existing domination by reducing political problems to measurable adjustment. Easton's later post-behavioural position acknowledged the need for relevance and values while retaining scientific method.

Further development: A full evaluation must also recognise the different standards at stake. Easton seeks methodological reconstruction; Strauss restores the rational ranking of regimes; Germino recovers enduring philosophical problems; and Marcuse treats criticism of domination as inseparable from knowledge. The revival succeeds only if these normative claims remain answerable to evidence. Otherwise, opposition to positivism can lapse into another form of untested doctrine. The post-behavioural synthesis is therefore a settlement, not a victory of philosophy over science. It preserves methodological pluralism within one discipline.

Critical evaluation: Strauss and Marcuse should not be collapsed: the former restores classical normative judgment, while the latter exposes social control and ideological conformity. Together they show why empirical sophistication alone is insufficient.

Conclusion: Taken together, these thinkers show that political theory survives by retaining scientific discipline while recovering the normative and critical capacity to judge political order.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.